

Anyone there?

IT WAS THE 23RD OF AUGUST, a Friday evening like any other, with me sitting and sipping on some hot tea while I started looking for emails from readers to answer. Around the 20th of every month, I'm reminded that we need to fill in letters into our inbox section, and that's when I end up dedicating a day to tracking those letters down and then replying to them, or forwarding them to other folk in Team Digit who might need to reply to the feedback. I've got so many Google accounts saved in my browser, that the account switcher has a long scroll bar. Scan for editor@digit.in, it's logged out? That's weird. Didn't I just login to it a few days ago? Click sign in, and it tells me to contact my administrator.

Long story short, someone accidentally deleted a lot of our G Suite email accounts by mistake, and a lot of emails from you readers went bye-bye for good. The lesson here is to make sure you drink a lot of caffeine when working late, and when you want to select multiple accounts, remember to just click on them one at a time instead of holding down [Shift] when selecting.

Sitting here with no emails whatsoever, and faced with the prospect of our first ever issue to not carry any reader feedback at all, I started looking at our social feeds, and realised that even there it's not really any in-depth feedback that's being given. We are, for all practical purposes, very alienated from you, our beloved magazine reader, especially if you don't take time to email us.

Of course, we still get loads of buying questions on a daily basis, so that's a pipeline of interaction that never dries up, but that is purely transactional, and need based. When it comes to discussions about new tech, new trends, talking to one another, learning from one another, there isn't any place that you and members of Team Digit can meet. We need to remedy that.

Our forums used to be that place, before social media killed them by making the world impatient and wanting immediate responses, or by dangling "likes" and "shares" as rewards. Plus, the move from desktop to mobile contributed greatly in killing off forums all across the globe, not just the Digit forum. Sure, it's still there and pretty active because of the forum enthusiasts who post

regularly, but it's a long, long way from how popular it was in its heyday. We still pay for its upkeep and server space and bandwidth only out of respect for the lakhs of Digit readers who once called it their online home.

However, we still need to find a way to be able to talk to you more often, and thus, I'm stuck with the predicament of finding out how. The email addresses are back now, and being backed-up in real time as well, because we've learnt our lesson in that regard, but even then, only about 1% of our readers write feedback emails to us or start up conversations. Perhaps most of you are shy, or perhaps you just don't have the time to sit down and type out a long email because of how busy your life is. Whatever the case, we need to find a way around that. I'm open to suggestions, because rather than try and force everyone to come to one single place to chat, we're happy to come where you spend your time online, but we're going to need to know where that is.

We have a Facebook group meant for geeks, but it's an inadvertently well-kept secret, and that needs to change. The group is called Digit Geeks on Facebook, and the direct link to it is: <https://www.facebook.com/groups/digitgeeks/>. We invite all of you to come join that group if Facebook is something you use often.

If Facebook is not your cup of tea, then we have started a telegram group as well, which currently only contains Team Digit members, but we'd love to be able to talk to you there as well, and more importantly, for you to also be able to talk to one another. Just download Telegram and use the invite link: t.me/digitgeek to come join us. Telegram is good because it allows you to stay anonymous to an extent, and you don't need to share your phone number.

If neither of those two is your cup of tea, you can still write in to us at editor@digit.in, and tell us where you like to hang out, and if one of us is on that platform, we'll connect with you there as well. In this day and age, none of us can afford to be disconnected from one another, especially not a group as closely bound together by the love of all things tech as the Digit family. See you around! 



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